

SORT 1 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Take every sheet set that has been demoted to this room and try each fitted sheet on the actual mattress. If a corner pops off while you are making the bed, it is a rag, not a spare. Fold each pillow in half and let go, and anything that stays folded goes out. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 2 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Nest each complete set inside one of its own pillowcases so a full change of bedding is a single grab from the shelf, and keep the spare set for this mattress size in this room rather than back in the family linen cupboard. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 3 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Vacuum the mattress surface and the seams with the upholstery tool, turn the mattress end to end, and wipe the top edge of the headboard, where dust settles unseen because nobody sits up in this bed. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY 4 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Walk from the pillow to the door with the lights off, the way a guest will in the small hours in a room they do not know, and clear anything their shin will find. If the bed sits under a blind, tie the cord up out of reach of a visiting toddler. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 5 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Write on a tag tucked into each bundle: bed size, one fitted, one flat, two cases, one blanket. A standard is the best way you know today, written down. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 6 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Bed and Linens Strip and wash the bed the day the guest leaves, not the day before the next one arrives, so the room sits ready rather than pending. One wash, by whoever waved them off. The check is the doorway: a made bed with a second set folded on the shelf is ready, and a bare mattress is a job left for a night you will be short of time ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT 7 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand Open the drawer and take out what has been hiding in a room nobody uses: dead batteries, a clock radio that lost its time when the power blipped, three paperbacks nobody chose, cough drops fused into their tin. None of it belongs to a guest, and none of it belongs to you either. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 8 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand Set the lamp on the side a right hand reaches first from the pillow, run the charger head over the top edge of the nightstand so it hangs where a hand lands, and stand the tissue box upright rather than laying it in the drawer. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 9 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand Wipe the lamp base and the inner rim of the shade, vacuum the drawer out rather than wiping it, and clean the water ring the last guest left because they could not find the coaster. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand The water glass, the lamp cord and the outlet all meet in one square foot here, so run the cord behind the nightstand rather than across the top, and keep the glass on the far side from the lamp. Take your own medication out of this drawer entirely, because a visiting child opens drawers before anything else. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand Tape a small card inside the drawer with the wifi name and password, where the bathroom is, and which way the shower tap turns. Write it out even for guests you know well, because the whole point is that nobody has to knock on your door at midnight to ask. The card stays in that drawer permanently, and the password is the one ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN GUEST BEDROOM Guest Nightstand The night before an arrival, switch the lamp on and plug your own phone into each cable while you make the bed, so a dead bulb or a failed cable is found by you rather than by them at two in the morning. Two minutes, host's job. Slip shows when you open the drawer and find something of the household's in it, because a drawer ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser This is where the household's undecided things hide behind a closed front: off-season jumpers, a bin of cables, wrapping paper and ribbon, a bag of outgrown baby clothes waiting on a decision about a second child. The jumpers go to your own wardrobe, the cables to the drawer that already holds cables, and the baby clothes get ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser Put the empty drawers at the top, where a guest opens first and bends least, and the spare linens underneath, since you fetch those twice a year and they fetch socks twice a day. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser Vacuum inside each drawer and wipe the runners, then leave the empty drawers open with the window cracked while you finish the rest of the room. Old wood holds a smell, and a guest's clothes take it on in one night. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser A dresser with two empty top drawers is lighter at the top than it looks, and a visiting child will climb it. Strap it into a stud, and pull each drawer fully out to check that it stops rather than sliding free onto a foot. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser Write on a label inside each empty drawer's front edge: reserved, guest. It stops the household reading a visibly empty drawer as an invitation, which is what happens to every empty drawer in an occupied house. Label the lower drawers by contents as well, spare linens for this bed, so nobody has to open all four to work out ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN GUEST BEDROOM Guest Dresser During your own seasonal wardrobe change you open these two drawers in the same trip and confirm they are still empty before the swap counts as done. Thirty seconds inside a job already happening, by whoever is doing the swapping. Slip is exactly one thing: something of the household's in a drawer labelled reserved. Recovery is ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT 19 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Take everything out and put it on the bed. This closet is where the house keeps holiday decorations, a wedding dress in a zipped bag, a box of old phones, and paperwork from two addresses ago. Sort by whether a named person will use it in a named situation, and route the rest out. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 20 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Give the guest the end of the rod nearest the door and nearest the light, put the household bins at the far end, and use matching hangers throughout so the empty six read as an offer rather than as leftovers. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 21 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Wipe the rod with a damp cloth, because a rod nobody touches grows a fuzz that transfers straight onto a dark shoulder, then vacuum the floor corners where dust gathers undisturbed for months. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY 22 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Anything stored above the rod sits over the head of whoever is reaching for a hanger. Move heavy boxes down to floor level and keep only light, lidded, labelled bins on the top shelf, with nothing stacked so the top item overhangs the edge. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 23 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Mark the guest boundary physically with a strip of tape on the rod or a hanger stop, so the line is visible from the doorway and does not depend on anyone remembering it. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 24 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Closet Every time you take a seasonal bin down from this closet you check the taped line and count the empty hangers before shutting the door, which costs the length of standing up. Six matching hangers past the tape is the number, so five is the signal and you read it without moving anything. Recovery is walking the stray garment ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT 25 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface Clear the surface completely. It will be holding gift wrap, an ironing pile that never made it back, a printer that has not been switched on this year, and paperwork someone brought in here to deal with in peace. The ironing goes back to the wardrobe it came from, the printer either earns a desk somewhere it gets used or leaves ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 26 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface Put the welcome bin where a guest sees it the moment they stand in the doorway, and set the luggage rack where a suitcase can open fully without hitting the bed frame or the closet door. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 27 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface Wipe the desk and the chair seat and back, both of which collect a dust film in an unused room, and check the desk lamp works now rather than during a guest's first evening. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY 28 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface The classic hazard here is the extension lead run across the floor because the only outlet is behind the bed. Move the desk to the outlet rather than the outlet to the desk, and if a suitcase must live on a folding rack, open it and lean on it to be sure it holds a packed case without folding. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 29 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface Photograph the room in its ready state and keep the print inside the lid of the welcome bin, so setting up is matching a picture rather than remembering a list. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 30 / 96 GUEST BEDROOM Guest Welcome and Work Surface When you carry the departing guest's sheets to the wash, the welcome bin comes with you and gets restocked on the way back. Host's job, five minutes. The ready-state photo inside the lid is the check, so slip is a comparison rather than a memory: whatever is in the photo and not in the bin is what you are missing. Recovery is ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT 31 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter Take everything off the counter and put back only what a visitor would use: soap, tissues, hand towel. The travel conditioner, the spare contact lens case, and the razor that ended up here because the main bathroom ran out of room all go back where they belong or into the trash. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN 32 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter Set the soap on the side your hand reaches without crossing over the basin, tissues at the back corner clear of splash, and the hand towel on a ring or hook visible from the door. A guest should never have to open a cabinet to find a towel. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE 33 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter Wipe the counter, then the tap and the drain lip where toothpaste film and hard water scale build up, including the collar at the base of the tap where a chalky ring hides. Do the mirror last, top to bottom, so drips land on surfaces you have not finished yet. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY 34 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter Water and electricity: a shaver or hair dryer left plugged in beside a full basin is a live cord within splash reach, so unplug it and put it away rather than coiling it on the counter. Swap any glass tumbler or glass trinket dish for ceramic, because glass on a wet counter slides and it breaks onto a tile floor where feet are ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE 35 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter Three things live on this counter permanently: soap, tissues, hand towel. Photograph that exact arrangement and tape the picture inside the vanity door, so anyone in the house can reset the counter without asking you which three. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN 36 / 96 GUEST BATHROOM Guest Vanity Counter The moment someone confirms they are coming over, walk in, top up the soap and hang a fresh hand towel, both done before you have put the phone down. The laundry version is smaller: when you put fresh towels away, the guest hand towel swaps in the same motion. Slip is a soap pump below half or a towel that has hung there since ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

46 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Shower or Tub

Fall: your guest is stepping into an unfamiliar tub, probably at night, on a surface they cannot judge the grip of. Put a non-slip mat or adhesive strips on the tub floor and make sure there is one thing solidly anchored to grab, because a towel bar screwed into drywall will tear straight out the moment it takes a person's ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

47 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Shower or Tub

Three bottles, one soap, one mat, one anchored grab point, and no personal items. If the shower has stood unused for a month, run it hot for a minute before a guest arrives, which clears the stale water sitting in the line and proves the drain is still running freely.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

48 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Shower or Tub

Whoever used it last squeegees the glass or shakes out the liner and drapes the bath mat over the tub rim. Since that person is often a guest who will not know, the host has a second version on departure: whatever they left in the shower comes out with the sheets. Slip is a pink line along the bottom edge of the liner or the ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

49 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

Clear everything from the top of the tank and the floor behind the bowl: the collection of air fresheners, the second brush, the magazines, the box of something nobody has identified in years. One reserve roll stays in the open. Nothing else.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

50 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

Put the reserve roll where a seated person can reach it without getting up, since that is the entire point of a reserve roll. Set the brush and the trash can on the side away from the door swing so nobody kicks either one on the way in.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

51 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

Treat the bowl first and let it sit under the rim and at the water line while you work outward: seat hinges, then the base of the pedestal, then the floor behind it, which is where splash and dust collect and where the smell in a guest bathroom actually comes from. Use a cloth in a color you use nowhere else in the house.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

52 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

Poison, choke, or strangle: a bottle of bowl cleaner parked behind the pedestal sits at a crawling child's eye level, usually with the cap loose. It goes back in the cleaning bin with the cap tight every time. It never shares a shelf with bleach, because bleach and an acid bowl cleaner mixed in a small room with the door shut ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

53 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

One visible reserve roll, backstock in the cabinet, brush dry in its holder, liner in the can, no ring at the water line. Write those five lines on a card and stand it in the cleaning bin, so the person holding the brush reads the standard at the moment they are able to meet it.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

54 / 96

GUEST BATHROOM

Toilet Area

Trash collection night is liner night in here. You are already standing in the room with a bag in your hand, so drop in a new liner and check the reserve roll is upright before you leave. Under a minute. Slip is a can with no liner, or a missing reserve roll, both visible from the door without bending. Recovery is those two ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Unfold every towel and look at it in daylight rather than closet light. Anything thin along the fold line, permanently gray, stiff from too much softener, or carrying a hair dye or nosebleed stain comes out of the guest stack. It becomes a rag or a car towel today. It does not go back just in case. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Store as complete sets rather than in stacks of like with like. Bath towel, hand towel, and washcloth folded into a single bundle so setting up for a visitor is one lift instead of three searches. Two bundles ready covers most households, and the bath mat lives underneath them. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Wash the stored set hot even though nobody has used it, because a towel that has sat folded in a closed closet all season carries a musty note that appears the instant it gets wet. Wipe the shelf, then run your hand along the back wall of the closet, since damp there is what the towels have been drinking. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Burn or fire: if this closet also holds the water heater, towels pressed against the tank, a hot pipe, or the heater's cable are a scorch and fire risk that no amount of neat folding fixes. Leave a hand's width of clearance around anything that gets hot, and never let a stack lean on the unit or trap its cable behind it. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STANDARDIZE GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Two complete bundles on the marked shelf with the bath mat beneath, and a mark on the shelf edge showing where the second bundle ends. When one is missing, the gap reads as a gap without anyone counting. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SUSTAIN GUEST BATHROOM Guest Linen Zone Departure is the trigger and it covers both rooms at once, so the used bathroom set comes off the rail into the same wash as the sheets. One load, one afternoon. The mark on the shelf edge shows where the second bundle ends, so slip is a gap rather than a count, read with the door open. Recovery is completing the missing bundle ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT DINING ROOM Dining Table Clear the whole table onto the floor in one armful, then sort what came off by owner rather than by type. The homework, the unopened mail, and the half-finished craft project each go back to a person, not back to the table. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	STRAIGHTEN DINING ROOM Dining Table Placemats, trivets, and the napkin basket belong in the nearest sideboard drawer, one step from where you set the table. Anything you find yourself carrying in from the kitchen twice a day is sleeping in the wrong drawer. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S	SHINE DINING ROOM Dining Table Run a fingernail down the leaf seam and the joint where the top meets the pedestal, because that is where crumbs collect and stay. Wipe the chair rungs and the underside lip of the table where hands grip it to pull a chair in. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY DINING ROOM Dining Table Lift and rock each chair to find a loose rung or a joint that has started working, and turn any chair that moves to face the wall so nobody sits on it before the joint is glued. Keep a trivet in the table's own drawer so a hot dish never lands on bare wood, and keep tall candles well clear of the runner ends. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> STANDARDIZE DINING ROOM Dining Table The centerpiece is the table's only permanent resident and its footprint is the boundary. Photograph the table both set and cleared, and tape both pictures inside the sideboard door so the right state is not something anyone has to remember. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Dining Table When the plates go to the sink, the homework, the mail and the craft box ride in the same trip, carried by the people who ate. Nothing waits for a second journey, because a second journey does not happen. The test is laying a place: if you have to move something first, the table has stopped being a table. Recovery is giving ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td></td>	STANDARDIZE DINING ROOM Dining Table The centerpiece is the table's only permanent resident and its footprint is the boundary. Photograph the table both set and cleared, and tape both pictures inside the sideboard door so the right state is not something anyone has to remember. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Dining Table When the plates go to the sink, the homework, the mail and the craft box ride in the same trip, carried by the people who ate. Nothing waits for a second journey, because a second journey does not happen. The test is laying a place: if you have to move something first, the table has stopped being a table. Recovery is giving ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td>	SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Dining Table When the plates go to the sink, the homework, the mail and the craft box ride in the same trip, carried by the people who ate. Nothing waits for a second journey, because a second journey does not happen. The test is laying a place: if you have to move something first, the table has stopped being a table. Recovery is giving ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SORT DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Take everything off the wood, including the picture frames and the candlesticks, and give every piece of paper a verdict tonight: act on it, file it, or recycle it. Burnt-down candle stubs, dried flowers, and chargers belonging to other rooms leave now. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> STRAIGHTEN DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Keep the end nearest the table entirely bare for setting dishes down, and group whatever display you keep at the far end near the lamp. Serving spoons and the trivet stack live in the top drawer directly beneath that bare end. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SHINE DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Lift each object rather than dusting around it, then work the wax drips off with a plastic card and gentle warmth, and treat the pale rings left by cold glasses. Dust behind the frames and along the back edge where the wall meets the wood. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td></td>	STRAIGHTEN DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Keep the end nearest the table entirely bare for setting dishes down, and group whatever display you keep at the far end near the lamp. Serving spoons and the trivet stack live in the top drawer directly beneath that bare end. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SHINE DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Lift each object rather than dusting around it, then work the wax drips off with a plastic card and gentle warmth, and treat the pale rings left by cold glasses. Dust behind the frames and along the back edge where the wall meets the wood. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td>	SHINE DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Lift each object rather than dusting around it, then work the wax drips off with a plastic card and gentle warmth, and treat the pale rings left by cold glasses. Dust behind the frames and along the back edge where the wall meets the wood. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S
SAFETY DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Trace the lamp cord from the shade to the outlet and count everything else sharing that plug, because a sideboard collects a lamp, a charger, and a warming tray on one socket hidden behind heavy furniture nobody pulls out. Move any candle sitting within arm's reach of a curtain or a wall hanging. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> STANDARDIZE DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface The taped run stays bare, always, and the display group is three objects at most. If you cannot set the roasting pan down without moving something first, the standard has already slipped. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Nothing sleeps on this wood overnight except the lamp and the three display pieces, so the last thing off it each night is whatever arrived that day, removed by whoever set it down. The taped run is the gauge and it reads from across the room: if you could not set a roasting pan on it now, the standard has gone. Recovery is ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td></td>	STANDARDIZE DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface The taped run stays bare, always, and the display group is three objects at most. If you cannot set the roasting pan down without moving something first, the standard has already slipped. SAFETY IS THE 4TH S <td> SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Nothing sleeps on this wood overnight except the lamp and the three display pieces, so the last thing off it each night is whatever arrived that day, removed by whoever set it down. The taped run is the gauge and it reads from across the room: if you could not set a roasting pan on it now, the standard has gone. Recovery is ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S </td>	SUSTAIN DINING ROOM Buffet or Sideboard Surface Nothing sleeps on this wood overnight except the lamp and the three display pieces, so the last thing off it each night is whatever arrived that day, removed by whoever set it down. The taped run is the gauge and it reads from across the room: if you could not set a roasting pan on it now, the standard has gone. Recovery is ... SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SORT

91 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Take every coat down. Anything that did not go outdoors once through the last cold season leaves, and so do the single gloves you kept in case the other one turned up. Off-season coats go to a bedroom closet, not to the far end of the same rail.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STRAIGHTEN

92 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Hooks for what goes on and off daily, hangers only for the wool coat that creases. Set the lowest hook at the height of the shortest person who uses it, and keep the two hooks nearest the door empty for visitors.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SHINE

93 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Brush the shoulders of the hanging coats, wipe the shelf where dust settles on top of the hat bin, and tip out the umbrella stand. There is always water and grit in the bottom of it.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SAFETY

94 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Hang your full weight on each hook before you trust it with a soaked winter coat. Hooks driven into plasterboard without an anchor pull out later, with the coat still attached and a lump of wall behind it.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

STANDARDIZE

95 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Write the contents and the season on the shelf bin, hats and gloves, winter, so whoever reaches up for it in October knows without opening the lid whether they have the right bin.



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

SUSTAIN

96 / 96

ENTRYWAY

Coat and Outerwear Zone

Whoever loads the washing machine walks the rail on the way past, under a minute, returning whatever was left on a chair back or the bannister. The count does the telling: two hooks stay empty, so a full rail read from the doorway means the room is already over. Recovery is carrying the two coats nobody wore this month up to a ...



SAFETY IS THE 4TH S

The standards that keep these zones

GUEST BEDROOM · GUEST BED AND LINENS

Two complete guest sets, each bundled in its own pillowcase and tagged with the bed size, and one of them always on the bed.

When you carry the departing guest's towels to the machine, the sheets come off the bed and go in with them.

GUEST BEDROOM · GUEST NIGHTSTAND

Lamp, two proven cables, tissues, coaster, wifi card. Nothing of the household's inside the drawer.

When you make up the bed for an arrival, you switch the lamp on and charge your own phone from both cables before you leave the room.

GUEST BEDROOM · GUEST DRESSER

Top two drawers empty and labelled reserved, lower drawers holding only spare linens for this room's bed, strap fixed to the wall.

When you swap your own wardrobe over between seasons, you check the guest drawers are still empty before the swap counts as finished.

GUEST BEDROOM · GUEST CLOSET

Six matching empty hangers past the tape line, a clear floor square for a suitcase, and every household bin lidded, labelled and below head height.

When you fetch or return a seasonal bin, you count the six hangers before you close the door.

GUEST BEDROOM · GUEST WELCOME AND WORK SURFACE

Clear desk, marked suitcase footprint, one labelled welcome bin with the ready-state photo inside the lid, and no cord crossing a walking line.

When the guest's sheets go into the machine, the welcome bin is restocked and put back before you leave the room.

GUEST BATHROOM · GUEST VANITY COUNTER

The counter holds three things: soap, tissues, hand towel. Anything a visitor brings leaves with them.

When you put away fresh towels after laundry, swap the guest hand towel in the same motion.

GUEST BATHROOM · GUEST VANITY STORAGE

Two labeled lift-out bins and a visible toilet paper stack. Nothing loose on the cabinet base, so a leak has somewhere obvious to show.

You already open this cabinet to get the brush for the weekly bowl clean, so run a hand across the base while you are down there.

GUEST BATHROOM · SHOWER OR TUB

One shampoo, one conditioner, one body wash, all readable and above a third full, over a non-slip tub floor.

When you strip the guest bed after a visit, carry out whatever the guest left in the shower on the same trip to the laundry.

GUEST BATHROOM · TOILET AREA

One reserve roll visible from the seat, a dry brush in a dry holder, a lined can, and no ring at the water line.

Trash collection night is liner night in here, and the reserve roll gets checked while you are holding the bag.

GUEST BATHROOM · GUEST LINEN ZONE

Two complete bundles, bath towel plus hand towel plus washcloth in each, and the bath mat folded beneath.

The guest's departure is the trigger: strip the bed and the bathroom together, wash them together, restock the shelf before you sit down.

DINING ROOM · DINING TABLE

Bare wood plus one centerpiece between meals, and every visiting activity arrives in its own container and leaves with it.

When the plates go to the sink after dinner, everything else on the table travels with them.

DINING ROOM · BUFFET OR SIDEBOARD SURFACE

The taped serving run stays bare, three display objects at the far end, and no paper on the wood at any hour.

When the day's mail comes through the door, it goes straight past this surface to the chair where you actually open it.

DINING ROOM · BUFFET OR SIDEBOARD STORAGE

A written count card inside the door, linens rolled with their napkins, platters on edge, and the heavy pieces on the bottom shelf.

When the tablecloth comes out of the dryer, it is rolled and returned before anything else in that load gets folded.

DINING ROOM · CHINA OR DISPLAY CABINET

A shelf photo inside the door, eight plates at most per stack with felt between, the weight on the bottom shelf, and the cabinet strapped to the wall.

When the last guest leaves, the good china is washed and back behind the glass before anyone turns the kitchen light off.

DINING ROOM · BEVERAGE OR COFFEE STATION

One tray, one outlet, use-order left to right, mugs capped at drinkers plus two, and a fill line on the jar.

While the morning coffee brews, the tray gets wiped and the jar gets topped back to its line.

ENTRYWAY · COAT AND OUTERWEAR ZONE

Two empty hooks at all times. If there is no empty hook, one coat is in the wrong room.

On the first morning cold enough that you go looking for gloves, that is the seasonal swap. Do it that morning, standing there, rather than noting it for later.